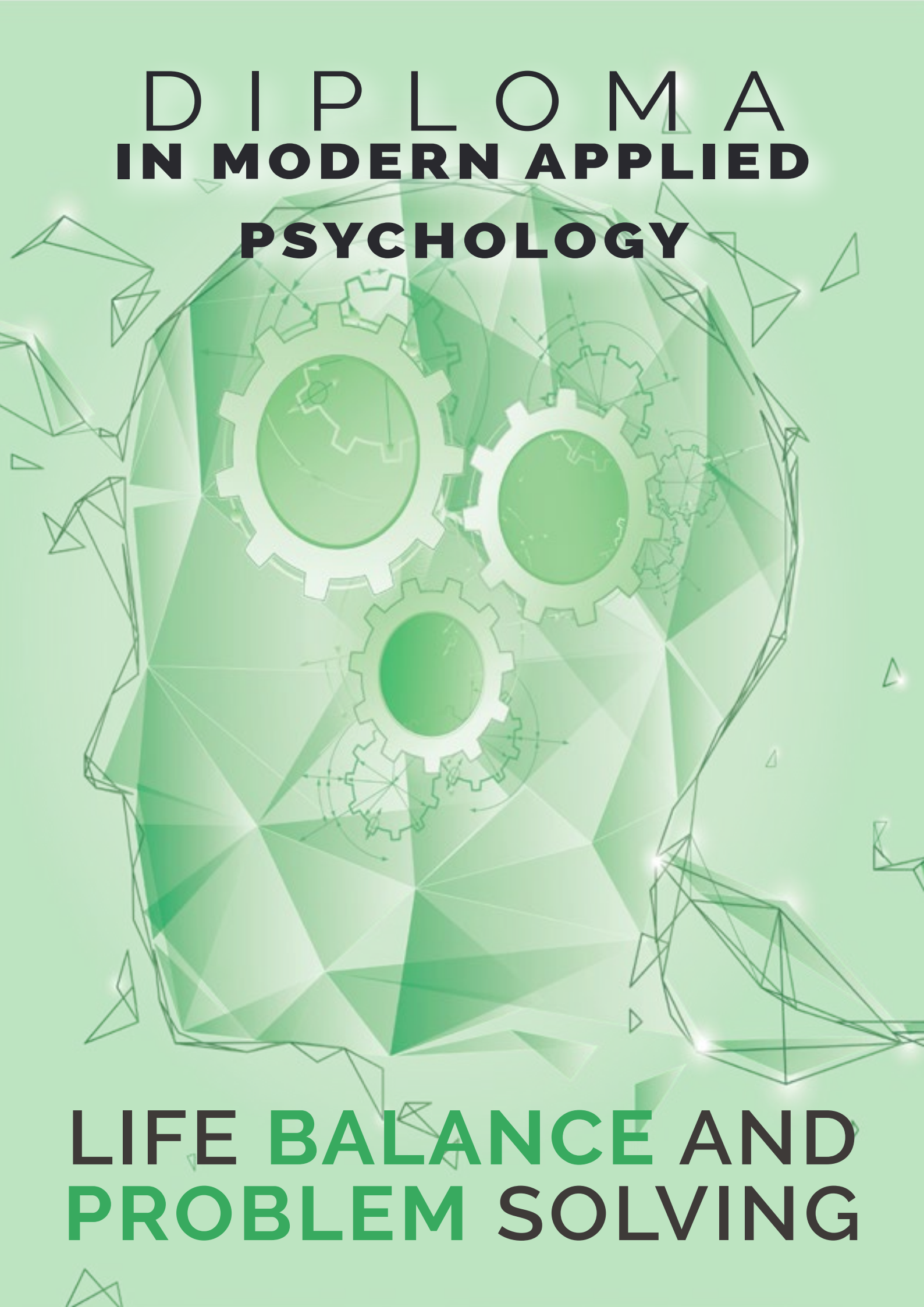


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a vibrant green with a complex, low-poly geometric pattern. Overlaid on this are three interlocking gears of varying sizes, rendered in a lighter green with white outlines. A faint, white wireframe of a human head is visible, with the gears positioned within the brain area. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological.

LIFE BALANCE AND PROBLEM SOLVING

LIFE BALANCE AND PROBLEM SOLVING

HOW DO WE SET ABOUT ACHIEVING GREATER HARMONY IN OUR LIVES?

In order to get the lives we want, or even greater fulfilment within our lives, it is necessary to take stock, and do so regularly.

All our lives are incredibly busy and demanding. Many of us work very long hours, and if we're not working we're receiving a constant barrage of stimulus, whether through social media, TV, advertising or just the fact that we're now so available through the electronic devices we carry. We wake in the morning to noise, we travel to work in noise. We work in between distractions. We go home in noise, watch TV whilst simultaneously scrolling through endless social media feeds, then head to bed.

In the midst of this routine, we need to be able to find purpose and meaning in how we're investing our time. We need to build loving and caring relationships with loved ones, friends and family. We may need to care for children and bring them up in a healthy way. We need fulfilment in our work and a sense of achievement. We need to pay the bills and maintain good mental health.

It is obvious that the lifestyle and the objective do not live happily side by side. Therefore we have to be strong enough to create space to examine what we're doing. We need to honestly assess our own perceptions of our lives and ask:

What is going on?

When we honestly examine what is going on in our lives, it is a certain bet that there will be one if not all areas that we are unhappy with. While the small dopamine hit that we receive from seeing someone has liked our social post is fleetingly pleasing, there is no lasting happiness, it is designed to need repeating endlessly. Then if we see that we are neglecting our real life relationships at the same time, then it is time to admit something may be out of balance, something may be wrong, and ask:

What do we want instead of what we've got?

This can be a shocking exercise if you have spent a long time hiding in the 'noise' of everyday life. Some people can hide there for a lifetime and only realise what they've done on their deathbed. It is unlikely that on that deathbed you are going to say, 'I wish I'd posted more on Instagram' or 'I wish I'd spent more time in the office' or 'I wish I'd got a higher score on my playstation'. You are likely to say, 'I wish I'd spent more quality time with my partner, or my children, or my parents' or 'I wish I'd honoured the friendships in my life and spent more time with the people I loved'. So when we take stock we need to ask:

What do we need to do to get there and what are we willing to do to get there?

As well as knowing what we really want, we also need a plan to get us there. What a plan should not be is a means of putting off action, there is always something you can do straight away, but you'll also be planning so that you know where to go next. Many people dream of a life they want, but the only thing they ever do towards obtaining it, is buying lottery tickets. They are in effect saying that they are not willing to do anything towards getting that life. By taking action immediately and by planning your next steps, you begin moving forward, and when you begin moving forward change will occur. You take stock, you take action and you plan and you:



Implement the plan.

The following exercise will help you to break your life down into seven main areas so that you can identify the specific areas in your life that are currently out of balance and therefore identify the likely causes of your stress and frustration.

People with a healthy life balance have clear prioritisation between work, which incorporates their career, education and ambitions and lifestyle, which combines their health, leisure & relationships.

No one in life is perfect, and no-one will ever achieve complete contentment in all of their primary life areas. However, it is always possible to establish a better balance - and this is what you're about to do.

"My point is, life is about balance. The good and the bad. The highs and the lows. The pina and the colada." — Ellen DeGeneres

Life balance and problem resolution is an ongoing process, which will always be shaped by the strategies we have for managing our lives. It's within these strategies that we can wind up misplacing our priorities and find ourselves falling out of balance.

This questionnaire has been designed to give you a holistic overview of all your seven most important life areas, before identifying the particular life areas in which you need to make immediate improvements.

Unfulfilled lives are always filled with "If onlys" These are the last words of those people who let life happen to them, rather than living it. Life is full of countless opportunities, for great successes and even more significant failures - we all learn through failure, so don't fear it. It's up to you to take the initiative, to make use of every opportunity that comes your way. Because if you don't, you stand at risk of being condemned to a life of mediocrity and regret — and no-one wants this!

Start working through the questionnaire and start taking stock of your life.

The late personal development expert Stephen Covey once suggested that:

'Without a clear focus on our guiding values and priorities, each of us runs a real risk of successfully climbing a very long ladder only to find it leaning against the wrong wall.'

This is why our core priorities are worth regular consideration, repeatedly, habitually and anytime we're about to devote time and energy to a new given pursuit.

Areas of Importance:

- Social & Family Relationships
- Career & Educational Aspirations
- Money & Personal Finances
- Physical Health, Recreation & Leisure



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

- Life's Routine Responsibilities
- Giving Back to Society & Contribution
- Mental, Emotional & Inner Wellbeing

The importance placed on these life areas will differ from person to person. However, if we can maintain an element of focus in all of our life areas, we will be more likely to achieve this healthy life balance.

By focussing on each area of importance in turn, we create awareness within us of what aspects of our lives need to be improved and those areas we have neglected.

Work through the questions & grade your answers from 1 – 10 circling the number that feels right to you, be instinctive and don't agonise over it.

MAIN LIFE AREA 1: **SOCIAL AND FAMILY RELATIONSHIPS**

My family relationships are very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with my family relationships?

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am close to my parents, and our relationships are healthy.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am close to my children, and our relationships are healthy.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

The people who matter the most in my life accept me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Social relationships are important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with my social relationships

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I have close friendships with people I can be myself around.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I have a good (real world) social network/ am part of social groups.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am good at connecting with new people.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I get along with my neighbours and the people in my area.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

I am satisfied with my romantic relationship/s?

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am happy with the overall quality of my relationships?

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about an area or areas in your relationships that you'd like to make changes in and say what you can start doing today:



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

"Man maintains his balance, poise, and sense of security only as he is moving forward." - Maxwell Maltz

MAIN LIFE AREA 2: CAREER & EDUCATION ASPIRATIONS

Achievements are important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with my career achievements to date

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I find my current work environment fulfilling

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I look forward to going to work each day

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My career stimulates and develops me as a person

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I have a healthy & rewarding work/ life balance.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My career is offering me advancement and reward

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Strong working relationships are important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am happy with my current working relationships

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My working environment positive and supportive

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I find contentment and fulfilment in my current career

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I would urgently like a career change.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

If I died today, I would be happy with the legacy I'll leave behind.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:
What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about an area or areas in your career or education that you'd like to make changes in and say what you can start doing today:

"There is no decision that we can make that doesn't come with some sort of balance or sacrifice." - Simon Sinek

MAIN LIFE AREA 3: MONEY & PERSONAL FINANCES

Being financially capable is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am content with my current financial effectiveness.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

I have enough money to meet my current wants.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I have enough money to meet my current needs.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I know my exact monthly outgoings.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I always know what's in my bank account/s.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Being generous to others is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am currently very generous towards others.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with how much I give to others

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Charitable contribution is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with how charitable I currently am.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am willing to step out of my comfort zone & take new risks to generate more income.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I worry a lot about my current financial situation.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?



LIFE BALANCE AND PROBLEM SOLVING

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about an area or areas in your personal finances that you'd like to make changes in and say what you can start doing today:

"To establish balance in our personal finances, it's crucial that we learn to live within our means." - Kain Ramsay

MAIN LIFE AREA 4: HEALTH, RECREATION & LEISURE

Establishing a healthy work/ life balance is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am content with my current work/life balance.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Physical health is critical to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am very happy with my current physical health

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am very happy with my current physical fitness levels.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Having plenty of 'free' time is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am very content with the amount of free time I have.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My physical appearance is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

I am content with my current physical appearance.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I can handle my stress and anxiety levels effectively.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I very much enjoy life outside of work/study.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am able to do things I enjoy frequently.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I have room for improvements in my life outside of work and/or study.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?



Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about an area or areas in your personal/social life that you'd like to make changes in and say what you can start doing today:

MAIN LIFE AREA 5: LIFE'S ROUTINE RESPONSIBILITIES

Managing routine tasks around the home is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with how I currently handle routine tasks.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am disciplined in paying my routine household bills.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I could be more disciplined in managing my bills & other important responsibilities.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Prioritizing my responsibilities is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with how I prioritise my responsibilities

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

A well-managed home environment is essential to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with my current home environment.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Dealing with home issues promptly is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Home life would be easier if I had a better system in place for managing my routine responsibilities.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I worry a lot about my routine responsibilities.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

My life would be so much easier if I were more disciplined in managing my routine responsibilities around the home.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about how you could become more efficient in managing your routine responsibilities and say what you can start doing today:

MAIN LIFE AREA 6: CONTRIBUTION & GIVING BACK TO SOCIETY

Contributing to society & making a difference is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with how much I currently give back to society.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

I regularly make a positive impact in the lives of other people.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am satisfied with the amount of difference I make in the lives of others.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Leaving behind a meaningful legacy is important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am happy with the current legacy that I would leave behind.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I encourage and support those closest to me often.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My time is mainly spent focussing on myself and my immediate needs.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I get involved with and support a social initiative that I genuinely believe in.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Those closest to me find great value in me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My peers or co-workers find great value in me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Someday my children will be proud of the way in which I've lived my life.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I could make more effort in contributing back to society.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What's going on?

What do I want instead of what I've got?



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about how you could begin making a greater impact in your culture or society and say what you can start doing today:

"Try not to become a person of success, but rather try to become a person of value." - Albert Einstein

MAIN LIFE AREA 7: MENTAL, EMOTIONAL & SPIRITUAL HEALTH

Being mentally healthy and strong is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I currently feel I am very mentally healthy and strong.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Being emotionally healthy and strong is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I currently feel I am very emotionally healthy and strong.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am confident and secure in who I am as a person.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

The way in which I am currently living my life is very fulfilling.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am very content with the way in which I am currently living my life.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Being spiritually healthy and strong is very important to me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I currently feel I am very spiritually healthy and strong.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

I regularly invest time into developing myself spiritually.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

I am consistently competent at managing my emotions. I have good self-control.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

My emotions will often manage me. I am undisciplined in self-control.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Negative and destructive emotions will often get the 'better' of me.

Disagree 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 Agree

Now answer the core questions about this area of your life:

What do I want instead of what I've got?

What do I need to do to get there and what am I willing to do to get there?

Implementation:

Write a personal vision statement about how you can begin developing yourself mentally, emotionally and spiritually and say what you can start doing today:



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

"A successful man is one who can lay a firm foundation with the bricks others have thrown at him." - David Brinkley

GENERAL LIFE-EVALUATION QUESTIONS

Q1) Summarise what your ideal life would be like.

Q2) What are the main challenges (or difficulties) that you're facing in bringing your life back into balance?

Q3) What areas of your life are working really well for you at the moment? (e.g. Family, work, fitness etc.)

Q4) What immediate changes do you need to make and what can you do today?

Q5) What words might other people use to describe you? (In relation to how balanced you are)



LIFE **BALANCE** AND **PROBLEM** SOLVING

"Success is a lousy teacher in life. It seduces smart people into believing that they can't lose." - Bill Gates

END OF WORKBOOK SUMMARY:

It's important to remember that life balance and problem resolution is an ongoing process and not just a means to an end. By regularly taking stock and reflecting on your life, writing down the issues and taking action, you will create an extraordinary life.

All you require is a constant sense of forward momentum. If you feel you have come to a stop or even reversing - take stock! By being specific, identifying goals and challenges and creating decisions based on action, you become powerful. You take control of your life and drive its direction.

Hopefully you have set some goals for yourself that are significant, meaningful, and will improve the quality of your life and others, once you have put in the hard work to achieve them.

Which of your seven main life areas are you going to bring back into balance first?

Notes:

